

We're Impressed

...By just how much you can do with PowerPoint, that is. Oftentimes, one just has to doff one's hat to the world's largest software company—and this, when we present you a book on Microsoft PowerPoint, is one such time. Here, we look at both PowerPoint 2003 and 2007—considering very much that a lot of you have upgraded, and that a lot of you haven't. PowerPoint 2002 (XP) users need not fret—the 2003 version isn't radically different, as you might know.

In our first chapter, we impress upon you the importance of presentations in general and how the corporate world is taking the PowerPoint way; we shan't repeat that here. Chapter 2 sees us getting into the soul of the matter—how to go about creating a presentation, how to use PowerPoint effectively for this purpose, and how to actually deliver one. Beyond that, it's all about the software.

So, starting chapter 3 onwards in this book, we've put together material on two things, though we haven't categorised it that way: (a) how to add specific things to presentations, and (b) how to modify what you've added. This covers everything we think will be needed to create a presentation from scratch. This also assumes you know nothing about the software at hand, although we do assume some familiarity with Windows!

We'll harp upon this point in chapter 2, but we should say it at the outset, here, because we'd sincerely like to discourage the reverse behaviour: we must tell you to think of PowerPoint as a tool to convey information—it's only a tool, *and* the purpose is to convey information. Never think that once you've created a marvellous presentation, your work is done.

But creating a marvellous presentation does go a long way towards getting your work done.